



Retro-Future EV

Ford has unveiled a retro 1970s concept electric pickup truck.
<https://digit.in/dec21-18>



Talk using brain implants

Brain implant translates paralysed man's thoughts into text with 94 percent accuracy.
<https://digit.in/dec21-19>

Funge Centralisation

Make privacy great again!

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Currently, the most common paradigm for software applications is centralised systems. From a single location, centralised systems govern the operation of separate units and the flow of information. To send and receive information and to be ordered, everyone is reliant on the central power. Corporate entities control major social media networks, and the rules of involvement are defined by a group of people within these corporations. The dependence on one entity creates a central point of failure for the service and gives the entity complete control over the service and the content on the platform.

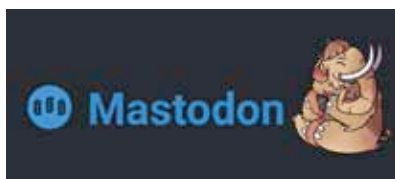
Envision an application that utilises the surplus processing power of thousands of computers across the world. Blockchain systems that allow smart contracts paved the way for such a concept to come to fruition into a good ecosystem of decentralised apps or DApps for short. DApps establish a new open-source software ecosystem that is safe and robust by running on a blockchain, peer-to-peer (P2P) network. A decentralised service has various characteristics that distinguish it from a traditional centralised service. The first significant distinction is that it isn't a single website that you can visit; instead, it is a network of hundreds of communities, each of which owns a copy of the code. Second, you can make your instance as public or private as you want it to be. Decentralised ecosystems are closely knit with cryptocurrency ecosystems, allowing creators to

monetise their content and earn tokens. So, there also is a burgeoning marketplace for selling items in return for cryptocurrency. Here are some DApp services that can help you take back control from big corporations:

SOCIAL MEDIA ALTERNATIVES

1. Mastodon

Mastodon is a decentralised, open-source alternative to Twitter, except it has a 500 character limit instead of 140. Mastodon, unlike other platforms, is decentralised, which means it is not managed by a single server, corporation, or individual. Mastodon allows anybody to construct and run their version of it called an "instance", with their own set of rules. As a result, rather than



a corporation tracking your data to sell to advertising, all instances are owned, controlled, and monitored by the community that created them. Mastodon instances are often crowdfunded rather than financed. Users inside an instance can follow one another, but they can also choose to follow users from different instances. While each Mastodon instance is run independently, users can connect with members of other servers without difficulty.

2. Aether

Aether is one of many emerging decentralised social media platforms. It's a peer-to-peer version of Reddit, featuring news aggregation and community discussion capabilities similar to Reddit. Aether is decentralising not only the technical components of its product but also the user governance. In other words, rather than being

subject to the whims of Reddit, Aether users get to govern themselves. One of the seemingly obvious pitfalls of a decentralised governing system is the existence of illegal content on it, but Aether has systems in place to censor such content. Aether maintains a "block list", which each of the clients can access, and if something posted on the network exists on the list, the clients will not broadcast it, effectively purging it. Aether has also taken the notion of ephemeral material from Snapchat, where content "eventually" fades from the P2P network.

3. Odysse

Odyssee is a video-sharing website similar to Youtube, aiming to recapture the freedom and independence of the internet, utilising the LBRY protocol. It was developed by the team behind the LBRY protocol, a blockchain-based file sharing and payment network. Odyssee seeks to provide an alternative to the regulated flow of information by giving people more influence over the site's content by working like a P2P data exchange, contrary to Youtube, that stores its data on centralised servers.

4. Manyverse

Manyverse seems like a regular social media app with all expected features like private messages, posts, likes etc., except it's a social network "off the grid" and is effectively spread across all the phones part of the network. Manyverse runs on the SSB (Secure Scuttlebutt) framework. Secure Scuttlebutt is a database of immutable append-only feeds that is geared for peer-to-peer replication. Every user has an immutable append-only log to which they can write. When you post something, your phone saves it locally first. Once you're connected to the Manyverse network, it gets uploaded through a local area network, Bluetooth or via the